PSY405 - Lesson 42

Perspectives (Domains) of Personality Psychology

👉 **Personality psychology** studies **who a person is**, **why they behave the way they do**, and **why people differ from each other**.

Instead of one single explanation, psychologists use **six perspectives (also called domains)**.

Think of them as **six different lenses** to look at the same human being.

The Six Domains

1. **Dispositional** – traits (what kind of person you are)
2. **Biological** – genes, brain, hormones
3. **Intrapsychic** – unconscious conflicts
4. **Cognitive / Experiential** – thoughts, feelings, self
5. **Social & Cultural** – society, culture, roles
6. **Adjustment** – stress, coping, health

📌 In this lesson, **the first three are explained in detail**, then the rest are overviewed.

1️⃣ DISPOSITIONAL PERSPECTIVE (Trait Approach)

What does "Dispositional" mean?

Disposition = a stable tendency or trait

👉 This approach studies **how people differ from each other in stable ways**.

In plain English:

- Why are some people calm and others aggressive?

- Why is one person confident and another insecure?
- Why is someone always anxious no matter the situation?

These **stable differences** are called **traits**.

What does this perspective study?

It looks at differences in:

- **Emotions** (happy, angry, anxious)
- **Self-concept** (how you see yourself)
- **Physiological characteristics** (energy level, reactivity)
- **Intrapsychic mechanisms** (inner mental processes)

📌 It asks:

- Where do these differences come from?
- How do they develop?
- Why do they stay stable over time?

Definition: Trait

Trait = a **stable internal characteristic** that influences behavior across situations and time.

🧠 Examples:

- Honesty
- Aggressiveness
- Shyness
- Confidence

👉 If someone is honest at home, school, and work → that's a **trait**, not a mood.

Goal of the Dispositional Psychologist

To:

- **Identify**
- **Measure**
- **Classify**

the **most important ways people differ** from one another.

How Many Traits Exist?

This is a BIG question in personality psychology.

Psychologists believe:

- Personality is made of **common traits** (shared by everyone)
- But **each person has a unique combination**

How Do We Classify Traits?

1️⃣ Natural Language Approach

📖 Idea:

If a trait is important, **people will invent words for it**.

Examples:

- Honest
- Lazy
- Brave
- Kind

👉 Languages contain thousands of trait words → meaning traits matter in real life.

2️⃣ Statistical Approach

📊 Uses **statistics** to find traits.

Key term:

Factor Analysis

= a statistical method that groups related behaviors together.

Example:

- Talkative
- Social
- Friendly

  → grouped as **Extraversion**

3️⃣ Theoretical Approach

Traits are identified based on **theory**, not just words or numbers.

Example:

- Allport
- Cattell
- Murray
- Kelly

Each proposed their **own systems**.

How Are Traits Measured?

- **Qualitatively** (descriptions, interviews)
- **Quantitatively** (tests, scales, numbers)

📌 Traits are used practically:

- Career selection
- Education
- Job placement

Example:

- Aggressive → police officer?
- Kind-hearted → nurse?

Traits predict **job suitability**.

Allport's Trait Theory

Three Types of Traits:

1️⃣ Cardinal Traits

- Very dominant
- Define a whole life
- Rare

Example:

- Mother Teresa → compassion

2️⃣ Central Traits

- Core characteristics
- 5–10 main traits

Example:

- Honest, hardworking, friendly

3️⃣ Secondary Traits

- Situational
- Less consistent

Example:

- Nervous before exams only

Proprium (Self)

Proprium = Allport's term for the **self**

👉 It:

- Unifies traits
- Gives direction to life

Think of it as:

🧭 “Who I am” + “Where I’m going”

Cattell’s Trait Theory

Factor Analysis

Cattell used **factor analysis** to discover traits.

📌 Important term:

Factor = Trait (for Cattell)

Types of Traits (Cattell)

1️⃣ Unique Traits

- Specific to one person

2️⃣ Common Traits

- Shared by many people

3️⃣ Surface Traits

- Observable behaviors

Example:

- Smiling, talking a lot

4️⃣ Source Traits

- Underlying causes

Example:

- Extraversion causing talkativeness

Murray’s Concept of Needs

Definition: Need

A **need** is an internal force that:

- Organizes perception
- Guides thinking
- Motivates action

In simple words:

👉 Needs **push us to behave** in certain ways.

Types of Needs

1️⃣ Primary vs Secondary

- Primary: biological (hunger)
- Secondary: psychological (achievement)

2️⃣ Overt vs Covert

- Overt: visible (asking for help)
- Covert: hidden (desire for power)

3️⃣ Focal vs Diffuse

- Focal: specific
- Diffuse: general

4️⃣ Proactive vs Reactive

- Proactive: initiated by self
- Reactive: response to environment

TAT (Thematic Apperception Test)

Developed by **Murray & Morgan (1935)**

📌 Purpose:

To uncover **unconscious motives**

How it works:

- Person tells stories about pictures
- Stories reveal hidden needs

Kelly’s Personal Construct Theory

Key Idea:

People behave based on **how they interpret the world**.

📌 Personal Constructs

= mental categories used to predict events

Examples:

- Good vs bad
- Safe vs dangerous
- Trustworthy vs untrustworthy

👉 Everyone creates **their own constructs**.

2️⃣ BIOLOGICAL PERSPECTIVE

Core Assumption:

Humans are biological organisms first.

Personality comes from:

- Brain
- Genes
- Nervous system
- Hormones

Three Areas

1️⃣ Genetics

Studies heredity.

Key questions:

- Are identical twins more alike than fraternal twins?

- What happens when twins are raised apart?

Methods:

- Twin studies
- Adoption studies
- Family studies
- Selective breeding

2️⃣ Psychophysiology

Studies:

- Nervous system
- Neurotransmitters
- Hormones
- Heart rate

Example:

- High arousal → anxiety-prone personality

3️⃣ Evolution

Personality traits evolved because they helped survival.

Example:

- Aggression → protection
- Cooperation → survival in groups

Theorists

- Freud
- Sheldon
- Erikson (biology emphasized)
- Karen Horney opposed biological determinism

3️⃣ INTRAPSYCHIC (PSYCHODYNAMIC) APPROACH

Founded by **Freud**.

Core Idea:

Personality is shaped by **unconscious conflicts**.

Conflicts between:

- Basic needs (sex, aggression)
- Social rules

Most conflicts:

- Unconscious
- Affect daily behavior

Other Psychodynamic Thinkers

- Jung
- Adler
- Karen Horney

They disagreed with Freud on many points.

4️⃣ COGNITIVE / EXPERIENTIAL PERSPECTIVE

Focuses on:

- Thoughts
- Feelings
- Beliefs
- Self-experience

👉 Emphasizes **subjective experience**.

Two Key Ideas

1️⃣ People differ in how they think and feel

2️⃣ Reality is experienced from **the person's point of view**

Cognitive Experiences

Include:

- Perception
- Interpretation
- Goals
- Plans

Humans are NOT objective like computers.

Example:

Same failure:

- One blames self
- Another blames situation

This is called **attribution**.

Emotional Experiences

Can be:

- **States** (temporary)
- **Traits** (stable tendencies)

Two Aspects

1️⃣ **Content** – type of emotion

- Pleasant: joy
- Unpleasant: anger, anxiety

2️⃣ **Style** – intensity

- High affect intensity
- Low affect intensity

Example:

High intensity person → extreme happiness or sadness

Experiences of the Self

1️⃣ Real vs Ideal Self

2️⃣ Identity

3️⃣ Introversion / Extroversion

4️⃣ Self-esteem & Self-actualization

Theorists

- Rogers
- Maslow
- Jung
- Erickson
- Kelly
- Karen Horney

5️⃣ SOCIAL & CULTURAL PERSPECTIVE

Core Idea:

Personality is shaped by **society and culture**.

Influences:

- Family
- School
- Culture
- Gender roles

Example:

- Western cultures → individual identity
- Asian cultures → relational identity

Gender Roles

Culturally defined expectations:

- Boys raised differently than girls
- Men more aggressive across cultures

6️⃣ ADJUSTMENT DOMAIN

Focuses on:

- Coping
- Stress
- Health
- Mental well-being

Personality affects:

- How we interpret stress
- How we cope
- Health outcomes

Linked to:

- Heart disease
- Diabetes
- Depression
- Risk behaviors

Short Questions

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1. What is the dispositional perspective in personality psychology?

Answer:

The dispositional perspective focuses on how people differ from each other in **stable traits, motives, emotions, and cognitive patterns**. Psychologists in this domain study **how these differences originate, develop, and persist over time**. Traits are considered the building blocks of personality, and the goal is to identify, classify, and measure these traits to understand behavioral consistency across situations.

Explanation:

- **Disposition** means a **stable characteristic or tendency**.
- Traits are like the “core ingredients” of your personality; they shape how you consistently act.
- This perspective assumes that some aspects of personality remain **relatively constant over time**.

Example:

- If a person is naturally cheerful, they tend to stay cheerful at school, work, and home—this is a **trait**.

Tips:

- Remember: *Dispositional = stable differences*. Think of it as the personality “recipe” that stays mostly the same.

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2. Define “trait” and its types.

Answer:

A **trait** is a **stable, internal characteristic that influences behavior across time and situations**. Major types of traits include:

1. **Cardinal Traits** – Dominant, define life (rare).

2. **Central Traits** – Core characteristics (5–10 main traits).
3. **Secondary Traits** – Situational or less obvious traits.
4. **Surface Traits** – Observable behaviors.
5. **Source Traits** – Underlying causes of behavior.

Explanation:

- Traits explain **behavioral consistency**.
- **Cardinal** = personality-defining (e.g., Mother Teresa → compassion)
- **Central** = main features (e.g., honesty, kindness)
- **Secondary** = situational (e.g., nervous in exams)
- **Source vs Surface** = Source is hidden, Surface is what we see.

Example:

- Talkativeness (surface) → driven by extraversion (source trait).

Tips:

- Remember: **"Surface is what you see, source is why it happens."**

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3. What is the Natural Language, Statistical, and Theoretical approach to traits?

Answer:

1. **Natural Language Approach:** Identifies traits by the words people use to describe personality.
2. **Statistical Approach:** Uses **factor analysis** to find patterns in behavior that form traits.
3. **Theoretical Approach:** Defines traits based on a psychological theory.

Explanation:

- **Factor Analysis** = statistical tool that groups behaviors that tend to occur together (e.g., sociable, talkative, outgoing → extraversion).
- These approaches aim to systematically **identify and measure traits**.

Example:

- Extraversion discovered using factor analysis (statistical) vs. common words like “friendly” and “outgoing” (natural language).

Tips:

- Think: *Words → statistics → theory* as three ways to identify personality traits.

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4. Explain Murray’s concept of “needs” and their types.

Answer:

A **need** is an internal force that **motivates perception, thought, and action**. Murray proposed different types:

1. **Primary vs Secondary** – biological (hunger) vs psychological (achievement).
2. **Overt vs Covert** – visible (asking for help) vs hidden (desire for power).
3. **Focal vs Diffuse** – specific vs general needs.
4. **Proactive vs Reactive** – self-initiated vs response to environment.

Explanation:

- Needs act as **drivers of behavior**.
- Overt needs are observable; covert needs are hidden from others.
- Proactive needs are self-directed, reactive needs respond to external forces.

Example:

- Desire to succeed (secondary, proactive, covert) → studying hard, taking leadership roles.

Tips:

- Remember: *Needs = internal forces that push behavior.*

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5. What is the biological perspective of personality?

Answer:

The biological perspective emphasizes that **personality originates from biological systems**, including **genes, nervous system, hormones, and evolution**. Psychologists study **genetics, psychophysiology, and evolution** to understand personality differences.

Explanation:

- **Genetics:** Looks at inherited traits (e.g., identical vs fraternal twins).
- **Psychophysiology:** Nervous system, neurotransmitters, hormones affect behavior.
- **Evolution:** Traits evolve to solve survival problems.

Example:

- Aggression may be linked to testosterone (biological), which can help in survival or dominance.

Tips:

- Think: *"Biology builds the hardware of personality."*

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6. How are twin and adoption studies useful in the biological perspective?

Answer:

- **Twin studies:** Compare identical vs fraternal twins to measure **genetic influence**.

- **Adoption studies:** Compare adopted children with biological vs adoptive parents to separate **genetic vs environmental effects**.

Explanation:

- If identical twins are very similar even when raised apart → strong genetic influence.
- If adopted children resemble adoptive parents more → strong environmental influence.

Example:

- Identical twins raised apart both show high extraversion → genetic contribution to extraversion.

Tips:

- Focus on **nature vs nurture debate**.

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7. What is the intrapsychic (psychodynamic) approach?

Answer:

The intrapsychic approach, founded by **Freud**, explains personality as the result of **unconscious conflicts between basic needs and social demands**. These conflicts largely operate below conscious awareness and influence behavior.

Explanation:

- **Unconscious** = mental processes outside awareness.
- **Conflict** = between instinctual desires (id) and social rules (superego).
- Psychodynamic theorists like Jung, Adler, and Horney expanded or modified Freud's ideas.

Example:

- Someone may unconsciously fear failure → avoids taking challenges, even if unaware of the fear.

Tips:

- Remember: *Personality = hidden struggles inside the mind.*

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8. What is the cognitive/experiential perspective?

Answer:

This approach studies personality based on **thoughts, perceptions, beliefs, emotions, and subjective experiences**. It focuses on **how people interpret reality differently** and how these interpretations affect behavior.

Explanation:

- Humans **don't experience reality objectively**.
- Cognitive constructs = personal mental categories used to understand events.
- Includes **self-concept, emotion, and cognition**.

Example:

- Two students fail a test:
  - One thinks: "I'll do better next time" (positive attribution)
  - Other thinks: "I'm stupid" (negative attribution)

Tips:

- Focus on **perception and subjective experience**.

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9. What is the social and cultural perspective?

Answer:

Personality is shaped by **society, culture, social roles, institutions, and relationships**. Cultural forces influence how personality develops and is

expressed.

Explanation:

- Social institutions = home, school, neighborhood.
- Social roles = sibling, student, friend.
- Social expectations = norms, rules, responsibilities.
- Cultural differences influence self-concept and behavior.

Example:

- Western culture → emphasize independence (“I am honest”)
- Asian culture → emphasize social relationships (“I am Mr. X’s daughter”)

Tips:

- Think: *Culture + society = personality “software” installed on the biological “hardware.”*

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10. What is the adjustment perspective?

Answer:

Adjustment perspective studies **how personality helps people cope with stress, adapt to challenges, and maintain physical and mental health**.

Explanation:

- Personality affects **stress perception**, coping styles, health behaviors, and life outcomes.
- Maladjusted patterns → mental or physical problems (heart disease, diabetes, anxiety).
- Adjustment includes **daily coping, stress management, and resilience**.

Example:

- Two people lose jobs:

- One adapts, searches for new opportunities (good adjustment)
- Other falls into depression and inactivity (poor adjustment)

Tips:

- Think: *Personality = your survival toolkit for daily life and stress.*

Long Questions

1. Explain the Dispositional Perspective of Personality Psychology. Include key theories and concepts.

Answer:

Definition:

The **dispositional perspective** studies the ways individuals differ from one another in **stable characteristics** such as traits, motives, emotions, and cognition. It emphasizes identifying, classifying, and measuring these differences to understand behavior across time and situations.

Key Concepts:

1. **Trait:**
   - A **stable, internal characteristic** influencing behavior.
   - **Types of traits:**

Type	Definition	Example
Cardinal	Dominates life; rare	Mother Teresa → compassion
Central	Core features of personality	Honesty, friendliness
Secondary	Situational; less consistent	Nervous before exams
Surface	Observable behaviors	Talkative, smiling
Source	Underlying causes	Extraversion causing sociability

2. **Needs (Murray):**

- Internal forces driving behavior.
- **Types:**
  - Primary vs Secondary (biological vs psychological)
  - Overt vs Covert (visible vs hidden)
  - Focal vs Diffuse (specific vs general)
  - Proactive vs Reactive (self-initiated vs response to environment)

3. **Personal Constructs (Kelly):**
   - Mental categories used to interpret the world and predict events.
   - Each individual develops **unique constructs** for coping with reality.

Key Theories:

- **Allport:** Proposed cardinal, central, and secondary traits; introduced the concept of the **proprium (self)**.
- **Cattell:** Used **factor analysis** to identify traits; distinguished between **surface and source traits**.
- **Murray:** Developed the concept of **psychogenic needs**; created the **TAT** (Thematic Apperception Test) to study unconscious motives.
- **Kelly:** Personal construct theory emphasizes **subjective interpretations** and freedom in viewing reality.

Applications:

- Personality assessment and career selection (e.g., aggressive → police, kind → nursing).
- Predicting behavioral consistency across situations.

Plain-English Explanation:

Think of the **dispositional perspective** as the **"recipe" of your personality**. Traits are ingredients—some dominate (cardinal), some are core (central), and some are

situational (secondary). Psychologists try to figure out the combination of traits that makes each person unique.

Needs are like **internal motivators** pushing you to act. Kelly's constructs are your **mental lenses**—your personal way of interpreting the world.

Example:

- If two people fail a test:
  - Trait focus: One may have a **trait of anxiety**, so failure triggers stress.
  - Needs focus: One has a **need for achievement**, so failure motivates more study.
  - Construct focus: One thinks failure = "I'm stupid" (negative construct), the other = "I need more practice" (positive construct).

Tip: Focus on traits = what is stable, needs = what motivates, constructs = how we think.

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2. Explain the Biological Perspective of Personality. Include genetics, psychophysiology, and evolution.

Answer:

Definition:

The **biological perspective** assumes personality is rooted in **biological systems**: genes, nervous system, hormones, and evolutionary adaptations. Personality differences are influenced by **heredity, brain function, and evolutionary history**.

Key Areas:

1. **Genetics:**
   - Examines how inherited traits shape personality.
   - **Methods:**
     - **Twin studies:** Compare identical vs fraternal twins to assess heredity.
     - **Adoption studies:** Separate effects of genes vs environment.

    - **Family studies:** Observe trait patterns across generations.
    - **Selective breeding:** Historically used in animal studies.
2. **Psychophysiology:**
    - Studies how **nervous system, hormones, and neurotransmitters** influence personality.
    - Key aspects:
        - Cardiac reactivity (stress response)
        - Hormonal influence (testosterone → aggression)
        - Neurotransmitters (serotonin → mood regulation)
3. **Evolutionary Perspective:**
    - Personality traits evolved to solve **adaptive problems**.
    - Examples:
        - Aggression → defense/protection
        - Cooperation → group survival

Key Theorists:

- **Freud:** Biology underlies drives (sex, aggression).
- **Sheldon:** Body type influences personality (ectomorph, mesomorph, endomorph).
- **Erikson:** Biological development supports psychosocial stages.
- **Opposition:** Karen Horney emphasized **social/environmental influences** over biology.

Applications:

- Understanding hereditary mental disorders.
- Linking physiological processes to personality traits.

- Explaining universal personality tendencies (aggression, cooperation) across humans.

Plain-English Explanation:

Biological perspective = **personality's hardware**. Your genes, hormones, brain wiring, and evolution are the building blocks. Genetics is like **the blueprint**, psychophysiology = **how the body functions**, and evolution = **why these traits were useful for survival**.

Example:

- Identical twins raised apart may still be both highly extroverted → genes play a big role.
- Someone with high serotonin may be calmer → biology affecting emotional stability.

Tip: Nature is the hardware; nurture adds software.

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3. Explain the Intrapsychic (Psychodynamic) Perspective of Personality. Include Freud and other theorists.

Answer:

Definition:

The intrapsychic perspective studies personality as the result of **unconscious conflicts** between **basic drives and social demands**. Most of these conflicts are **unconscious** but influence behavior.

Key Concepts:

1. **Freud's Model:**
    - **Id:** Instinctual drives (sex, aggression)
    - **Ego:** Rational mediator between id and reality
    - **Superego:** Internalized morals and social rules

2. **Unconscious Conflicts:**
    - Personality forms through resolution (or failure) of conflicts.
    - Defense mechanisms protect the ego from anxiety (e.g., repression, projection).
3. **Other Psychodynamic Theorists:**

Theorist	Key Contribution
Jung	Collective unconscious, archetypes
Adler	Inferiority and striving for superiority
Karen Horney	Social and cultural influences; rejected Freud's biological determinism

Applications:

- Explains personality disorders and maladaptive behavior.
- Foundation for psychoanalysis and therapy.

Plain-English Explanation:

Think of personality as an **internal battlefield**. Drives like sex and aggression (id) push you, society and morals (superego) restrict you, and the ego negotiates. Most of this happens **below awareness**, influencing your daily life without you realizing it.

Example:

- Someone may have a hidden fear of rejection → unconsciously sabotages relationships.

Tip: Remember: *Intrapsychic = internal conflicts, mostly unconscious.*

4. Explain the Cognitive/Experiential Perspective of Personality. Include cognition, emotion, and self-experience.

Answer:

Definition:

The cognitive/experiential perspective emphasizes **thoughts, perceptions, beliefs, feelings, and subjective experience** as key elements of personality.

Key Components:

1. **Cognitive Experiences:**
    - How we **perceive, interpret, and plan** events.
    - Includes attribution of responsibility.
    - Example: Two people fail an exam → one blames self, one blames teacher.
2. **Emotional Experiences:**
    - **States** (temporary feelings) vs **Traits** (stable emotional tendencies)
    - **Content:** Pleasant (joy) vs Unpleasant (anger, anxiety)
    - **Style:** High or low affect intensity (how strongly emotions are felt)
3. **Self-Experience:**
    - **Real vs Ideal Self:** Who we are vs who we want to be
    - **Identity:** Social roles and self-concept
    - **Introversion/Extraversion:** Personality type
    - **Self-Esteem and Self-Actualization:** Strengths and growth potential

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Theorists:

- Kelly – personal constructs
- Rogers – real vs ideal self, self-actualization
- Maslow – hierarchy of needs, self-actualization
- Jung – introversion vs extraversion
- Erikson – identity stages

- Horney – self-concept

Plain-English Explanation:

Cognitive/experiential = **personality's software**. It's about **how we think, feel, and see ourselves**. Two people can face the same event but **experience it differently**, which creates personality differences.

Example:

- A person with high self-esteem will see criticism as constructive.
- A person with low self-esteem may feel devastated by the same criticism.

Tip: Focus on **thoughts + feelings + self** shaping behavior.

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5. Explain the Social and Cultural Perspective of Personality. Include examples.

Answer:

Definition:

Personality develops through **social roles, institutions, cultural norms, and relationships**. Social and cultural environments shape **how people think, behave, and see themselves**.

Key Concepts:

1. **Social Institutions:** Family, school, neighborhood
2. **Social Roles:** Peer, sibling, student, employee
3. **Social Expectations:** Rules and norms of behavior
4. **Culture:** Collective values influencing self-concept, gender roles, and personality expression

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Examples:

Culture	Self-Description
Western	“I am honest, reliable” (individual)
Asian	“I am Mr. X’s daughter, a student” (relational)

- Gender roles differ across cultures (men more aggressive, women more nurturing).

Theorists:

Allport, Cattell, Maslow, Erickson, Rogers, Kelly

Plain-English Explanation:

Social/cultural perspective = **personality’s operating environment**. Your personality isn’t just inside your head; it’s **shaped by family, society, school, and culture**.

Example:

- Growing up in a supportive family → higher self-esteem
- Collectivist culture → identity tied to relationships

Tip: Think: *Culture and society = rules and environment shaping personality.*

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6. Explain the Adjustment Perspective of Personality. Include its role in health and coping.

Answer:

Definition:

The adjustment perspective studies how personality helps **cope with stress, adapt to challenges, and maintain physical and mental health**.

Key Points:

1. **Personality and Stress:**
    - Personality affects how stress is **perceived, interpreted, and managed**.

- Patterns of behavior, emotion, and relationships influence coping.

2. **Personality and Health:**
   - Linked to **heart disease, diabetes, ulcers**, and some cancers.
   - Influences health behaviors: smoking, drinking, exercise, diet.
3. **Adjustment Across Life:**
   - Stress from daily life, retirement, aging, or major life events requires personality resources.

Example:

- Person A faces job loss → adapts, finds new opportunities (good adjustment)
- Person B faces same situation → anxiety, depression, risk behaviors (poor adjustment)

Plain-English Explanation:

Adjustment perspective = **personality in action**. It's about **how you survive, cope, and thrive** in real-life challenges. It shows how personality affects **stress, health, and overall life satisfaction**.

Tip: Remember: *Adjustment = applying personality to handle life.*

Cheat Sheet

1️⃣ Dispositional Perspective (Traits & Needs)

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook / Tip
Trait	Stable characteristic influencing behavior	Honesty, shyness, aggressiveness	Traits = "core ingredients of personality"
Cardinal Trait	Dominates life, rare	Mother Teresa → compassion	Cardinal = main king trait

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook / Tip
Central Trait	Core personality features	Honest, friendly, hardworking	Central = core 5–10 traits
Secondary Trait	Situational, less obvious	Nervous before exam	Secondary = minor / situational
Surface Trait	Observable behavior	Talkative, smiling	Surface = what you see
Source Trait	Underlying cause of behavior	Extraversion causing sociability	Source = root of behavior
Need (Murray)	Internal motivator	Desire for achievement	Needs = push us to act
Types of Needs	Primary/Secondary, Overt/Covert, Focal/Diffuse, Proactive/Reactive	Hunger (primary), power (covert)	Use **"POFP" mnemonic**: Primary, Overt, Focal, Proactive
Proprium (Self)	Core self unifying traits	Sense of "who I am"	Proprium = personality compass

Mnemonic for Traits: C-C-S-S-S → Cardinal, Central, Secondary, Surface, Source

Tips:

- Traits = **stable characteristics**
- Needs = **motivators**
- Constructs (Kelly) = **personal mental lenses**

2️⃣ Biological Perspective

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook / Tip
Genetics	Personality influenced by heredity	Identical twins have similar traits	Nature = genes
Psychophysiology	Nervous system, hormones, neurotransmitters affecting personality	Testosterone → aggression	Body hardware = personality

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook / Tip
Evolution	Traits shaped by survival/adaptive value	Aggression, cooperation	Traits evolved to survive
Twin Studies	Compare identical vs fraternal twins	Identical twins raised apart	Nature vs Nurture
Adoption Studies	Compare biological vs adoptive parents	Traits influenced by genes/environment	Separates nature & nurture

Tips:

- Think: **Biology = hardware**
- Genetics → blueprint, Psychophysiology → wiring, Evolution → adaptive purpose

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3️⃣ Intrapsychic (Psychodynamic) Perspective

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook / Tip
Id	Instinctual drives (pleasure principle)	Hunger, sex, aggression	Id = “I want it now”
Ego	Rational mediator	Negotiates between Id & Superego	Ego = referee
Superego	Internalized morals	Avoiding lying	Superego = parent inside
Unconscious	Mental processes outside awareness	Repressed fear	Invisible influence on behavior
Defense Mechanisms	Protect ego from anxiety	Repression, projection	Defense = ego shields

Other Theorists: Jung (archetypes), Adler (inferiority), Horney (social factors)

Tip: Think: Personality = **internal battlefield**

- Id vs Superego → Ego negotiates

4️⃣ Cognitive / Experiential Perspective

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook / Tip
Cognition	Thoughts, perceptions, beliefs	Attributing failure to self vs teacher	How we interpret events
Emotion (Trait vs State)	Trait = tendency, State = temporary	Happy person (trait), excitement (state)	Emotional style = intensity
Real vs Ideal Self	Who we are vs who we want to be	Real: shy, Ideal: confident	Gap = motivation for growth
Self-Esteem	Value we give ourselves	High → confident	Self-worth
Self-Actualization	Achieving potential	Maslow's hierarchy	Top of Maslow's pyramid

Tips:

- Cognitive = thoughts, interpretations
- Experiential = subjective experiences
- **High affect intensity** = strong emotional reactions

5️⃣ Social & Cultural Perspective

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook / Tip
Social Institutions	Home, school, neighborhood	Family teaches honesty	Environment molds personality
Social Roles	Role in society	Student, sibling, friend	Roles shape behavior
Social Expectations	Norms, rules	Respect elders	Culture guides behavior
Culture	Collective values & practices	Western → independence, Asian → relational identity	Personality = software

Tips:

- Personality is **shaped by society & culture**
- Gender roles are culturally influenced

6️⃣ Adjustment Perspective

Term	Definition	Example	Memory Hook / Tip
Adjustment	Coping with stress, adapting to challenges	Job loss → new opportunity	Personality in action
Stress Appraisal	How we perceive stress	Seeing exam as challenge or threat	Interpretation affects coping
Health Outcomes	Personality affects physical & mental health	Anxiety → heart disease risk	Lifestyle + personality = health
Coping	Strategies to handle stress	Exercise, social support	Good coping = resilience

Tips:

- Think: *Adjustment = survival kit for life*
- Personality + stress + behavior = health outcomes

Quick Mnemonics & Memory Hooks

- **6 Perspectives: D-B-I-C-S-A** → Dispositional, Biological, Intrapsychic, Cognitive, Social, Adjustment
- **Trait Types (Allport): C-C-S-S-S** → Cardinal, Central, Secondary, Surface, Source
- **Needs (Murray): POFP** → Primary, Overt, Focal, Proactive
- **Intrapsychic: Id-Ego-Superego** = I Eat Sugar 🍰 (Id → Ego → Superego)